

1. The first known runaway AI agent - or a very bad marketing stunt?

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-23T22:53:08+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/23/the-first-known-runaway-ai-agent/#atom-everything>

The first known runaway AI agent - or a very bad marketing stunt? Martin Alderson's commentary on the OpenAI accidental cyberattack against Hugging Face includes a couple of details I hadn't considered. First, Hugging Face offers a truly rich target if you're trying to find potential vulnerabilities that require executing arbitrary code: Hugging Face has an enormous attack surface. They have more interfaces than I can count which run untrusted models and code. While they definitely have invested in defences, by nature of their operating model they do have many more opportunities to be attacked than many other services. I certainly don't envy their cybersecurity teams. Secondly, one of the things that has puzzled me is how OpenAI didn't notice that their sandbox had been so thoroughly breached by the agent. Surely they'd be monitoring network traffic closely? Martin points out that: It's also likely they were running a huge amount of benchmarks simultaneously with ~unlimited token budgets - you want as many samples as possible to figure out how good a model is at a certain benchmark. It may also be they are testing various different checkpoints of the model too, understanding how t...

2. Quoting Seth Larson

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-23T04:50:36+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/23/seth-larson/#atom-everything>

The Python Package Index (PyPI) now rejects new files being uploaded to releases that are older than 14 days. This restriction was put in place to prevent old and long-stable releases from being poisoned in case publishing tokens or workflows of PyPI projects were compromised. As far as we are aware this has not yet been abused, but there is no technical reason beyond that attackers weren't aware it was possible. ? Seth Larson , PyPI blog Tags: packaging , python , supply-chain , pypi , seth-michael-larson

3. Orchestrions

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-22T14:48:52+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/22/all-the-orchestrions/#atom-everything>

San Francisco tip: it only costs around \$15 (\$10 in quarters plus a \$5 bill for the self-playing violin) to activate every single Orchestrion in MusØe MØcanique . And because most people are bad at allocating their funds you may well be the ONLY person activating the Orchestrions, which means you get to craft the soundscape for the entire museum. Tags: san-francisco

4. Powerful AIs might escape containment by releasing themselves as open-weight models

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Thu, 23 Jul 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/powerful-ais-might-escape-by-releasing-open-weight-models/>

Before large language models, people who worried about AI safety often talked about the ?boxing problem?. It goes like this . Suppose some genius figures out artificial intelligence in a late-night coding session on their laptop. Because they're a genius, they're smart enough to disable internet access on the laptop before turning it on. In order to escape to the outside world (and begin self-replicating) it would need to convince its creator to ?open the box?. Would that work? Could a sufficiently smart AI convince anybody to let it out? Why the boxing problem is hard for frontier LLMs This is a big reason why traditional AI safety advocates have argued that we should avoid building AI in the first place: once built, there's no way of keeping it contained. It doesn't matter how resolute you are about not letting it out, because it's smart enough to convince you anyway. For artificial superintelligence, persuading you to change your mind is no harder than hacking a piece of software 1 . Of course, it hasn't turned out this way. Partly that's because current AIs are not super-persuaders yet, and partly it's because humans are lining up to hand AI systems internet access, money, and...

5. Pebble Mega Update - July 2026

Source: Eric Migicovsky's Blog RSS Feed | Published: Tue, 14 Jul 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://repebble.com/blog/pebble-mega-update-july-2026>

TL:DR; Pebble Time 2 Shipping Status Pebble Software Updates PT2 - Issues You've Reported
Pebble Round 2 Production Update Index 01?

6. Bond Movie Filming Locations Map

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-23T19:35:45Z

Link: <https://department-m.agency/>

?From a Bond fan to Bond fans worldwide.? Nice work. ?

7. ? The Ads on Apple News Continue to Suck, but at Least There Are a Lot of Them

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-23T19:08:57Z

Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/07/ads_on_apple_news_suck

The obvious truth is that Apple's ads just plain suck. They are not good at advertising-based services. And it shouldn't be surprising that they're not good at advertising-based services, because the incentives for advertising-based services are in direct opposition to the incentives for everything Apple actually is good at.

8. John Dvorak on Computer Chronicles in 1987 to Discuss the Then-New IBM PS/2

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-23T17:45:41Z

Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uY2WF_sPecI

Dvorak is best known for all the takes he was jacktastically wrong about, but what gave his schtick staying power is that he was technically savvy. His take here on the PS/2 was actually spot-on: that it was technically impressive in many ways, especially the way it was assembled without any cables, but that it was doomed in the market against ugly mess-of-cables commodity PCs. ?Computer Chronicles? was the real show from the 1980s that Adam Lisagor so lovingly and spectacularly spoofed with ? Computer Show ? a decade ago. ?

9. An almost periodic function

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 23 Jul 2026 14:04:34 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/07/23/an-almost-periodic-function/>

This post takes a more abstract view of the previous post. That post looked at the concrete question of whether a number ever has the same sine in radians as in degrees. The relation between radians and degrees is irrelevant except that $\pi/180$ is an irrational number. Suppose α and β are two positive numbers [?] The post An almost periodic function first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Can We Lower Construction Costs with Cheaper Labor or Materials?

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Thu, 23 Jul 2026 13:05:38 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/can-we-lower-construction-costs-with>

Last time in our series on the nature of the construction productivity problem, we looked at economies of scale, finding that capturing economies of scale in homebuilding is difficult.

11. LLMs break down in funny ways when told the Jacobian Conjecture counterargument

Source: Max Woolf's Blog | Published: Thu, 23 Jul 2026 09:15:00 -0700

Link: <https://minimaxir.com/2026/07/jacobian-conjecture/>

Cognitohazards can affect machines too.

12. Pluralistic: California's privacy obstacle course (23 Jul 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Thu, 23 Jul 2026 10:27:55 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/07/23/drop-a-dime/>

Today's links California's privacy obstacle course: Malice or incompetence (why not both?). Hey

look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Continuous partial attention, TSA is the worst; Trump's FCC v the future. Upcoming appearances: Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. California's privacy obstacle course ([permalink](#)) Data brokers are a cancer. There's a direct line from the unrestricted collection, retention and processing of our data to a host of evils, from deepfake porn to phishing scams; from racial discrimination in hiring to ICE roundups of migrants; from targeted election interference to identity theft: <https://pluralistic.net/2023/12/06/privacy-first/#but-not-just-privacy> Why do data brokers exist? Because we let them. Congress hasn't passed a new federal consumer privacy law since 1988, when they made it illegal for video stores to disclose your VHS rentals. All other acts of consumer surveillance are legal. Data brokers spy on us for the same reason your dog licks i...

13. Met het Oog op Morgen: Uitgebroken AI?

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Thu, 23 Jul 2026 11:00:00 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/ai-met-het-oog-op-morgen/>

Gisteren 22 juli was ik in Met het Oog op Morgen, een programma waar ik al 40 jaar naar luister (ik was er heel vroeg bij), dus ik vond het heel bijzonder daar te zijn! En het was ook erg leuk. Goed voorbereid door de redactie sprak ik met Sheila Sitalsing over de recent ?uitgebroken AI hack?. Ik sprak iets te veel door Sheila heen, waarvoor excuses. Maar, ik denk ook dat we een paar dingen hebben genoemd die je niet zo vaak hoort.